GLOBAL STEWARDSHIP COUNCIL

FOUNDING CHARTER

2026 San José / Paris Framework

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This Charter belongs to no nation, no individual, and no political party. It belongs to the Earth and to the generations who will inherit it.

PREAMBLE: FROM STATE SECURITY TO EARTH STEWARDSHIP

We, the founding Member States of the Global Stewardship Council, acknowledge that humanity stands at a civilisational crossroads — and that the architecture we inherit was not designed for this moment.

The 1945 United Nations Charter was built in the shadow of a particular war by a particular set of victors. It brought relative stability for eighty years. It also codified a world order in which five nations — those who had won — granted themselves permanent veto power over all collective action, and in which the peoples of Asia, Africa, the Middle East, and the Americas were largely excluded from the tables at which their futures were decided.

The consequences of that exclusion persist. The straight lines drawn across the Middle East in 1916 without consulting those who lived there. The partition of Palestine in 1947 by a UN dominated by the same victors, without a plebiscite of the existing population. The partition of the Indian subcontinent by a foreign official in five weeks, drawing lines that displaced fifteen million people and created nuclear flashpoints that persist today. The overthrow of a democratically elected government in a resource-rich nation in 1953 to protect foreign commercial interests. The subsequent history of a painstakingly negotiated multilateral nuclear agreement, then unilaterally abandoned by a departing signatory, leaving a legacy of mistrust that continues to shape nuclear diplomacy today. These were not aberrations of the 1945 system. They were its logical expression: sovereignty for the powerful; partition for the rest.

THE ROOT CAUSE DOCTRINE

We hereby incorporate as a universal principle of this Charter the recognition that sustainable peace requires addressing root causes. The history of unilateral treaty abrogation, the conduct of strikes against civilian infrastructure absent Security Council authorisation, and the pattern of attacking parties who are actively negotiating in good faith — these are not peripheral grievances. They are the tectonic forces that destabilise regions and destroy the trust upon which any durable peace must be built. No ceasefire that ignores these underlying fractures can endure. No peace process that treats history as an inconvenience can succeed. The Global Stewardship Council is founded on the premise that justice delayed is conflict extended, and that the work of peace includes the work of historical reckoning.

THE AI AMPLIFICATION CRISIS

We further acknowledge a danger that the architects of the 1945 system could not have foreseen: the emergence of artificial intelligence as an amplifier of human emotion and geopolitical volatility at civilisational scale. Algorithmic systems — optimised for engagement, outrage, and conflict — have accelerated the decision cycles of leaders and populations alike, compressing the time available for reflection, diplomacy, and de-escalation. Social media platforms powered by AI have made it possible for a single statement — whether a threat, an insult, or a provocation — to reach billions of people within seconds, foreclosing the diplomatic space that crises require. The 2026 Middle East conflict demonstrated with painful clarity how AI-amplified rhetoric can push the world to the brink of catastrophe faster than any institutional architecture can respond. We name this danger explicitly so that every provision of this Charter that addresses AI governance is understood not merely as a technical regulation, but as a civilisational survival measure.

The world does not need AI to make us more intelligent. It needs AI governance that broadens our perception — our capacity to see the full human consequences of our choices before we make them. As one framework of wisdom notes: if a person's perception is narrow, even high intelligence operates only within the confines of that narrowness; but broadened perception enables understanding that transcends intelligence alone.

THE SPACE IMPERATIVE AND THE CHOICE BEFORE US

Unless the trajectory of armed conflict is changed on Earth, humanity will carry its wars into space. The first weaponised satellite becomes the first space weapon. The first space weapon becomes the first space war. The resources, talent, and civilisational energy that could open the cosmos to all of humanity will be consumed by the extension of terrestrial violence beyond the atmosphere. This Charter is written in the conviction that humanity must make a choice: to continue investing in the architecture of destruction, or to begin investing — with the same urgency and the same resources — in the architecture of stewardship, exploration, and shared flourishing.

The war that produced the Islamabad Ceasefire of April 2026 and the NPT Review Conference that opens April 27, 2026 are not separate crises. They are one crisis — and the Global Stewardship Council is one framework designed to address all of them simultaneously.

We do not dissolve the United Nations. We propose to refresh it — for those nations willing to move forward — on a new foundation: Earth Stewardship. Under this principle, sovereignty is not an absolute privilege. It is a fiduciary duty.

THE CORE SHIFT:
From 'the right to dominate' to 'the duty to protect.'
From 'might makes right' to 'stewardship makes right.'
From winner-determined maps to people-determined sovereignty.
From algorithms without accountability to humans who bear legal responsibility for every lethal decision.
From wars that consume our civilisational energy to a shared future among the stars.

PART I: THE STRUCTURAL SHIFT — OLD UN vs. GLOBAL STEWARDSHIP COUNCIL

FEATURE	OLD UN (1945 CHARTER)	GSC (2026 CHARTER)	WHY IT MATTERS
Power Logic	Veto power for the 'Big 5'	Weighted Stewardship Majority — contribution makes right	Power from military victory 80 years ago cannot produce justice today
Voting Threshold	P5 veto blocks any resolution	Ordinary: 60%. Constitutional: 75%. Emergency: 2/3	Perpetual deadlock enables perpetual impunity
Primary Duty	Territorial integrity & state security	Earth Stewardship and rights of present and future generations	Security without ecology is a temporary arrangement
Governance Base	New York — host-nation pressure	San José, Costa Rica — demilitarised, neutral, biodiverse	Neutrality cannot be governed from the most powerful nation
Nuclear Accountability	Nuclear states veto their own accountability	Nuclear threats trigger automatic Coercion Penalty	No system survives when those with the most dangerous weapons hold the veto
AI Governance	No binding framework	Human-in-the-Loop; Agentic AI prohibition; Emotional Amplification Protocol	2026 crisis showed unregulated AI in military/political contexts is existential risk
Cultural Bridge	No formal mechanism	One Orbit / Many Voices programme; ping-pong diplomacy mandate	Trust is built between people before it is built between governments
Funding	Voluntary dues — often unpaid	Sovereign Data Royalty, Stewardship Credits, defence conversion	The body holding nations accountable cannot be held hostage by their dues

ARTICLE I: PURPOSES AND PRINCIPLES

Section 1 — The Principle of Earth Trusteeship

The primary purpose of the Council is the preservation and restoration of the Earth System. Sovereignty is no longer an absolute privilege but a fiduciary duty. Each Member State acknowledges that it holds its territory, natural resources, linguistic heritage, and data infrastructure in trust for the benefit of all living beings and future generations.

This principle draws from the Haudenosaunee Seventh Generation teaching, Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam ('the world is one family'), and the 40,000-year wisdom of the San people of southern Africa — who maintained radical resource-sharing, distributed leadership, and deliberate regulation of ego as social technology more durable than any treaty.

Section 2 — Abolition of Hegemonic Hierarchy and Voting Thresholds

The Veto Power of the previous era is hereby abolished. No single nation, regardless of military or economic size, shall have the power to obstruct the collective will of the Council.

DECISION TYPE	REQUIRED MAJORITY	EXAMPLES	RATIONALE
Ordinary Resolution	60% of weighted votes	Annual budget, membership applications	Standard democratic threshold
Emergency Resolution	2/3 + quorum of 50% of members	Nuclear threat; AI targeting violation; Planetary Boundary emergency	Urgency requires broad coalition
Constitutional Amendment	75% + ratification by 2/3 of member states within 18 months	Changes to Charter Articles; new institutions	Fundamental changes need supermajority legitimacy
Core Principle Protection	Unamendable	Abolition of veto; Human-in-the-Loop; Seventh Generation Audit; nuclear emergency response; One Orbit programme	Some protections must be beyond political reach
Quorum	50% by count AND 60% by weighted vote	All binding resolutions	Prevents 'rump' majorities from binding absent members

Section 3 — The Seventh Generation Audit

THE AUDIT QUESTION: If this action is taken today, will the people living 140 years from now — seven generations hence — have a liveable, biodiverse, and politically just world to inhabit? The burden of proof lies with the proposing party to demonstrate safety, not with the opposing party to demonstrate harm.

1. The Future Generations Ombudsperson may flag any proposed Council action within 14 days of formal notice.
2. A panel of three independent assessors is convened: one from the Ombudsperson, one from the proposing party, one from the Indigenous Elders Council.
3. The panel has 90 days to assess against five criteria: (a) biosphere viability; (b) climate trajectory; (c) nuclear and weapons risk; (d) political and civic freedom; (e) intergenerational equity of resource distribution.
4. The panel's finding is advisory but must be publicly published and formally addressed before any vote on the flagged action.
5. If the panel finds irreversible harm to any criterion, implementation is suspended until a 75% weighted majority votes to override — with a formal statement of justification entered permanently into the record.
6. Appeals may be submitted to the Dispute Resolution Chamber within 30 days of a panel finding.

Section 4 — Nuclear Accountability and War Crimes Penalties

§4.1 — Automatic War Crimes Penalty (60% Coercion Penalty, within 48h)

- Strikes on civilian infrastructure, including hospitals, schools, water treatment facilities, power grids serving civilian populations, and cultural heritage sites;
- Assassination or attempted assassination of a sitting head of state or head of government;
- Use of military force against a state that is actively engaged in diplomatic negotiations with the attacking party — regardless of whether those negotiations are public or conducted through intermediaries;
- Use of military force without prior authorisation from the UNSC or, where the Security Council is paralysed by veto, without a 2/3 emergency majority from the GSC Council Assembly.

This provision makes the pattern of attacking negotiating partners legally cognisable and structurally costly — ensuring that no future power can gain strategic advantage by initiating military action while negotiations are underway.

§4.2 — Nuclear Threat Penalty (40–80% Coercion Penalty)

- Issuing an explicit or implicit nuclear threat (including threats to destroy civilian infrastructure 'of a whole civilisation');
- Conducting a nuclear weapons test;
- Deploying nuclear weapons inconsistently with the NPT, or to a non-nuclear state without Council authorisation;
- Refusing IAEA inspection of a facility under Additional Protocol obligations.

§4.3 — Nuclear Use

Nuclear use — even 'limited' or 'tactical' — constitutes automatic grounds for an emergency Council session within 72 hours and activates the full Graduated Response Protocol. Nuclear use against civilian populations is referrable to the International Criminal Court.

§4.4 — Restoration of Standing

The Coercion Penalty remains in effect until: (a) the triggering act is formally acknowledged to the Council Assembly; (b) an independent verification mission confirms de-escalation; and (c) the state re-engages with binding multilateral frameworks. Restoration is automatic upon verified compliance. This Charter does not seek permanent punishment — it seeks persistent consequence until behaviour changes.

Section 5 — Ceasefire Verification Protocol

Within 48 hours of any ceasefire agreement, the Council shall deploy a five-nation neutral verification team with access to real-time satellite imagery, ground-based monitoring stations, and open-source intelligence feeds. The verification team issues public reports every 72 hours during the first 30 days of any ceasefire, and weekly thereafter.

§5.2 — Lebanon Parallel Track Requirement

No ceasefire agreement shall be recognised as complete if it excludes active conflict theatres in adjacent states demonstrably connected to the same underlying dispute. Any diplomatic process addressing nuclear or regional security arrangements in a conflict region shall simultaneously address all connected conflict theatres. The Council designates a standing mediation panel of three neutral Member States to be activated for any parallel track within 24 hours of a ceasefire announcement. This provision prevents the strategic use of 'excluded theatres' to undermine ceasefire frameworks.

Section 6 — AI Governance: The Human-in-the-Loop Standard

No Member State may deploy artificial intelligence in any system that recommends, selects, or executes lethal force without meeting the following Human-in-the-Loop Standard:

REQUIREMENT	STANDARD	RATIONALE	ENFORCEMENT
Qualified human reviewer	Commissioned officer O-4 or above, trained in IHL and certified in AI-assisted targeting review	AI cannot replace conscience, only augment it	Violations trigger Coercion Penalty; referral to ICC under Rome Statute Article 28
Minimum review time	No less than 60 seconds of active deliberation per individual targeting decision	Speed of operations cannot be used to bypass moral responsibility	Documented and auditable; speed requirements in interface design are violations
Documentation	Each decision logged: reviewer ID, timestamp, AI recommendation, human decision, justification for divergence	Accountability requires a paper trail	Records maintained by SDVO; discoverable in war crimes proceedings
Meaningful refusal	Reviewing commander must have technical access and legal authority to refuse, modify, or delay any decision at any point	If refusal is structurally impossible, the human is not 'in the loop'	Interface design eliminating refusal capacity is a violation regardless of formal compliance
System certification	All AI targeting systems certified by independent technical body before deployment; certification lapses after 24 months	Technology evolves; certification must keep pace	Non-certified systems may not operate in GSC member territories

Section 7 — Agentic AI in Nuclear Systems: Absolute Prohibition

ABSOLUTE PROHIBITION — UNAMENDABLE: No Member State may deploy, authorise, or permit any agentic artificial intelligence system — defined as any AI capable of autonomous goal-directed action without continuous human oversight — in any system that:

(a) has access to nuclear launch codes, nuclear weapons status systems, or nuclear command-and-control networks;

(b) monitors, models, or responds to adversary nuclear posture in real time;

(c) generates targeting recommendations for nuclear or radiological weapons;

(d) operates within the decision chain for any system that could trigger, escalate, or misinterpret nuclear alerts.

This prohibition cannot be overridden by any Council majority, any national security justification, or any treaty provision. An agentic AI in a nuclear decision chain introduces the possibility of extinction-level error that cannot be recalled, reversed, or apologised for.

ADDITIONAL REQUIREMENTS:

• All nuclear command-and-control systems must include verified 'air gaps' — physical disconnection — between AI systems and any system with nuclear access;

• Any AI system providing nuclear threat assessment must include a mandatory minimum 72-hour human review period before any change in nuclear posture is authorised;

• Member States shall submit to annual IAEA-led technical inspections of nuclear command-and-control AI interfaces, with findings published publicly.

ARTICLE I §7A – LETHAL AUTONOMOUS WEAPONS SYSTEMS TARGETING HUMAN BEINGS – NOT JUST NUCLEAR COMMAND CHAINS DISTINCT FROM NUCLEAR PROHIBITION

PROPOSED NEW ARTICLE I §7A —
LETHAL AUTONOMOUS WEAPONS SYSTEMS (LAWS): ABSOLUTE PROHIBITION ON AUTONOMOUS LETHAL TARGETING OF HUMAN BEINGS

§7A.1 — DEFINITION: A Lethal Autonomous Weapons System (LAWS) is any weapons system that, once activated, can independently search for, detect, classify, select, and engage a human target without a human operator making the decision to kill — including systems that:

(a) use thermal/infrared imaging, visual AI, acoustic targeting, or any combination thereof to autonomously identify and lock onto human targets;

(b) once locked, pursue and engage without requiring further human authorisation;

(c) operate in time-frames that preclude meaningful human review (i.e. where the 60-second standard of **Article I §6** cannot be met by design).

§7A.2 — ABSOLUTE PROHIBITION — OFFENSIVE LAWS: No Member State may deploy, authorise, or permit any LAWS for offensive operations against human beings. This prohibition is:

- Absolute — no military necessity argument overrides it
- Unamendable — it cannot be removed from the Charter by any majority
- Universal — it applies to all Member States regardless of size or military capacity

§7A.3 — DEFENSIVE EXCEPTION — STRICTLY DEFINED: Automated defensive systems (e.g. missile interception, incoming drone neutralisation in scenarios where human response is physically impossible) may be permitted ONLY where:

(a) the system targets only incoming weapons, not human beings;

(b) the system has a physical 'kill switch' that any authorised human operator can activate to immediately halt all engagement;

(c) the system is certified annually by an independent technical body;

(d) the operator on duty has received documented training and must physically confirm 'system armed' at intervals not exceeding 4 hours.

§7A.4 — THERMAL TARGETING SPECIFIC PROHIBITION: No Member State may deploy any system that autonomously detects a human body via thermal/infrared signature and engages that human without an explicit, documented, per-person kill authorisation from a qualified human commander (O-4 or above). This provision is technology-neutral — it applies regardless of how the thermal detection is implemented.

§7A.5 — VERIFICATION: Member States submit to annual independent inspections of autonomous weapons programmes. Inspection findings are published publicly. Non-compliance triggers the Coercion Penalty (**Article I §4**).

RATIONALE: The Arctic thermal-lock drone scenario — in which a human target is detected, locked, and killed without any human in the decision chain — is the most fundamental violation of human dignity possible. The right not to be killed by a machine that made the decision to kill you, without a human being ever choosing to do so, is the most basic right that international law must now protect. This provision makes that right enforceable.

Section 8 — AI's Role in Geopolitical Escalation: The Emotional Amplification Protocol

The Council recognises that **artificial intelligence** — through algorithmic content curation, automated translation, social media engagement optimisation, and synthetic media generation — has become a primary mechanism for the amplification of fear, outrage, and geopolitical hostility at scale. The 2026 Middle East crisis demonstrated that AI-amplified rhetoric can compress the decision cycle of nuclear-adjacent states to hours, eliminating the diplomatic breathing room that crises require.

Member States are required to implement the following **Emotional Amplification Protocol**:

- No AI-generated or AI-amplified content threatening the use of force against a Member State may be distributed through government communications channels during active diplomatic negotiations;
- Social media platforms operating in Member State jurisdictions must implement mandatory 'cooling delays' of not less than four hours on content containing nuclear threat language during declared Council emergency periods;
- Member States shall maintain national-level AI monitoring units capable of identifying and publicly flagging synthetic media (deepfakes, voice cloning, fabricated statements) within 24 hours of detection;
- The Council's AI Monitoring Office shall publish a quarterly Geopolitical AI Risk Report identifying the platforms and content categories most responsible for escalatory amplification.

This is not censorship.

It is the recognition that in a world where algorithms select

what billions of people see about geopolitical events:

*the **design** of those algorithms*

*is **itself** a matter of war and peace.*

Section 9 — The Prohibition on Coercive Economic Acts

The following acts, when applied without Council authorisation, trigger the Coercion Penalty:

- Imposition of tariffs exceeding WTO-bound rates when used as leverage for political compliance;
- Economic blockades against civilian populations;
- Extraterritorial sanctions applied against third-party states or companies trading with a Council member under Council-endorsed frameworks;
- Transnational repression of diaspora communities — including surveillance, intimidation, or coercion;
- Use of debt instruments to extract political compliance from smaller economies.

ARTICLE II: MEMBERSHIP — FOUNDING STEWARDS AND PATHWAY TO ACCESSION

The GSC is not a closed club. It is an open invitation. Any nation willing to accept the fiduciary duties of Earth Stewardship, submit to the Weighted Stewardship Index, and participate in the Seventh Generation Audit mechanism may apply for membership.

Tier 1: Founding Stewards — Core Architecture Committee

ROLE	WHY ESSENTIAL	STRATEGIC FUNCTION	COALITION BREADTH
World's largest democracy	1.4 billion people; natural bridge between Global South and G7; unmatched moral authority on AI data rights	Co-architect; provides Global South legitimacy that Western nations alone cannot	Bridges non-Western and democratic perspectives; counterweight to both major power blocs
Nuclear-armed Muslim-majority mediator state	Only nuclear state trusted simultaneously by major Western powers, major Islamic nations, Gulf states, and major Asian powers; demonstrated April 2026 Islamabad Ceasefire mediation	Tier 1 Founding Steward; permanent Regional Dialogue Secretariat for South and West Asia	Provides the missing link across security frameworks, Islamic world diplomacy, and nuclear dialogue
Anchor G7 Western state	G7 member; neutral convener; rich natural assets; independent foreign policy stance	Lead convener and charter drafter; provides 'responsible Western state' credibility	Anchor of Western democratic values; signals GSC is not anti-Western
Major EU / European state	World's most advanced AI governance framework; largest trading bloc; Anti-Coercion Instrument	Legal and institutional architecture; ensures transatlantic continuity	Institutionalises rules-based order with full European weight
Major Francophone Security Council state	UNSC permanent member; nuclear deterrent willing to submit to GSC oversight	Security Council insider credibility; bridges Old UN and New GSC architectures	Maintains Western security credibility while supporting veto abolition
Pacific G7 state (nuclear attack survivor)	Only nation to have suffered nuclear attack in war — unimpeachable moral authority on nuclear accountability	Pacific anchor; moral authority on nuclear trauma; AI governance partner	Essential Asia-Pacific democratic anchor

ARTICLE III: THE WEIGHTED STEWARDSHIP INDEX

VOTE WEIGHT (V) = (P + B + S + D) ÷ (4 × (1 + C))

P = Population Factor | B = Biodiversity Index | S = Sustainability Score

D = Democracy & Human Rights Index | C = Coercion Penalty (0.0–1.5)

Nations GAIN influence by protecting ecosystems, meeting climate targets, and upholding democratic rights.

Nations LOSE influence through nuclear threats, economic coercion, strikes on civilian infrastructure, or AI targeting without human oversight.

No nation retains a veto. Every nation retains a voice.

FORMULA VERIFICATION: Optimal (C=0, all factors=1.0): V = 4.0 ÷ 4 = 1.0 ✓

High penalty (C=1.5, factors avg 0.5): V = 2.0 ÷ 10 = 0.2 ✓

Maximum penalty does not eliminate voting weight ✓

CODE	FACTOR	WHAT IT MEASURES	DATA SOURCE & ANTI-GAMING RULE
P	Population Factor	Population as proportion of median member, capped at 3× median	UN Population Division. Five-year rolling averages prevent census manipulation.
B	Biodiversity Index	Health and extent of protected ecosystems: forests, oceans, wetlands, grasslands, species diversity	IPBES + IUCN Red List. Satellite verification required; self-reported figures not accepted.
S	Sustainability Score	Adherence to the Nine Planetary Boundaries as defined by the Stockholm Resilience Centre	Stockholm Resilience Centre + IPCC. Historical emissions included — 'dirty start, clean pivot' strategies cannot inflate scores.
D	Democracy & Human Rights Index	Independent judiciaries, press freedom, minority protections, absence of systemic repression	Freedom House + V-Dem Institute + UN Human Rights Council — three independent sources triangulated.
C	Coercion Penalty	Applied for: nuclear threats; military aggression; strikes on civilian infrastructure; assassination of heads of state; agentic AI in nuclear systems; illegal economic coercion. Range: 0.0–1.5	Three-member Coercion Assessment Panel. Decisions appealable within 30 days.

ARTICLE IV: FUNDING — SOLVING THE UN FINANCIAL CRISIS

FUNDING STREAM	MECHANISM	SCALE ESTIMATE	LEGAL PRECEDENT
Sovereign Data Royalty	0.5% gross revenue royalty paid by any AI company with market capitalisation exceeding $1 trillion USD using sovereign linguistic or cultural data for LLM training	Potentially several billion USD annually	Multiple national AI transparency acts; EU AI Act Art. 53
Stewardship Credits	Nations earn annually tradeable credits for carbon sequestration, biodiversity protection, freshwater conservation, and ocean health. Anti-manipulation: SU Integrity Board audits with satellite verification.	$50–100B annually by 2030	Kunming-Montreal Biodiversity Framework; Paris Agreement Article 6
Voluntary Defence Conversion	Member States may redirect up to 1% of annual military budget to the Planetary Boundary Restoration Fund, receiving voting credits	1% of $2.4 trillion global military spending = $24B if fully subscribed	Constitutional demilitarisation precedents
War Cost Transparency Fund	All Member States in armed conflict publish annually: total military expenditure + equivalent civilian value (hospital-years, children educated, space science programmes, reforestation). Opportunity cost of war as permanent accountability mechanism.	Non-financial; democratic and reputational accountability	Seventh Generation Audit principle extended to military spending

ARTICLE V: INSTITUTIONS, ARCHITECTURE, AND GRADUATED RESPONSE

The Council Assembly

All Member States participate on the basis of their Weighted Stewardship Index score. The Assembly meets in regular session twice annually and in emergency session within 72 hours of any nuclear threat, AI-assisted strike without human-in-the-loop compliance, agentic AI incident in a nuclear system, or Planetary Boundary emergency.

The Stewardship Commission

A standing executive body of 15 members elected for three-year terms. No member may hold executive office in a member state government simultaneously.

The Secretary-General

Elected by 60% weighted majority for a single five-year term. May not be a national of any state currently subject to a Coercion Penalty.

The Future Generations Ombudsperson

Independent officer, single five-year term, renewable once. Has the right to flag any proposed action for Seventh Generation Audit, address the Assembly, and commission independent expert reports. May not be removed except by 75% weighted vote.

The Indigenous Elders Council

Consultative body of Indigenous knowledge-holders from all bioregions. Right to address the Assembly on any matter relating to land stewardship, water rights, biodiversity, and intergenerational obligations. Elders Council consensus finding carries 10% additional weighting in Seventh Generation Audit panels. Members are nominated by their own communities, not appointed by governments.

The AI Monitoring Office

A permanent technical body established by this April 2026 update to monitor AI-amplified geopolitical escalation, certify AI targeting systems, inspect nuclear command-and-control AI interfaces, and publish the quarterly Geopolitical AI Risk Report. Operates under the same independence guarantees as the SDVO.

Section 7 — The Regional Dialogue Secretariat

The Council may designate permanent Regional Dialogue Secretariats in Member States that have demonstrated unique mediation capacity. The first such designation is the Secretariat for South and West Asia, to be hosted by the nuclear-armed Muslim-majority mediator state that brokered the April 2026 Islamabad Ceasefire. The Secretariat shall maintain a standing mediation capacity, host annual regional stewardship dialogues, coordinate with the Ceasefire Verification Protocol, and report annually to the Council Assembly.

Graduated Response Protocol

STAGE	TRIGGER	MECHANISM	TIMELINE
1 — Diplomatic	Any alleged Charter violation	Formal notification + 30-day response window + mediated dialogue	0–60 days
2 — Arbitration	No resolution at Stage 1	Binding arbitration by three-member panel; findings publicly published	60–180 days
3 — Economic Measures	Failure to comply with arbitration	Targeted Stewardship Credit suspension; access restrictions to Council programmes	180 days +
4 — Collective Response	Continued non-compliance or acute emergency (nuclear use, mass atrocity, agentic AI incident)	Assembly votes: asset freezes, trade embargoes, ICC referral, and — as last resort, 2/3 emergency majority — collective defence authorisation	Emergency: 72 hours

HONEST ENFORCEMENT DOCTRINE: The GSC does not maintain a standing military force and cannot physically prevent a military action in real time. This Charter acknowledges this limitation honestly. What the GSC can do: impose graduated economic and diplomatic costs that make aggression progressively more expensive; reduce the aggressor's international legitimacy and voting weight; refer individuals to the ICC; and, as a last resort with a 2/3 emergency majority, authorise collective defence. The goal is not instant enforcement but persistent consequence — making sustained aggression so diplomatically and economically costly that it becomes irrational.

ARTICLE VI: DOMESTIC IMPLEMENTATION AND THE 'ONE ORBIT — MANY VOICES' PROGRAMME

SECTOR	RESPONSIBILITY	SPECIFIC ACTIONS	ACCOUNTABILITY
Subnational Governments	Active Earth Citizenship education	Global Stewardship Studies: Seventh Generation Audit, Planetary Boundaries, AI literacy, digital sovereignty. Mock GSC Assembly debates from the perspective of future generations. 'Belief Autopsy' exercise: helping students identify whether their views are genuinely their own or algorithmically shaped.	Annual reporting to GSC open-data portal
Municipalities	Local environmental monitoring	Form Bio-Regional Councils monitoring local water quality, soil health, air quality, and biodiversity. Data feeds directly into GSC environmental monitoring grid.	Real-time satellite verification; public portal
Individuals	Data sovereignty	Move personal data to Sovereign Cloud cooperatives in jurisdictions with strong data protection laws. Use tools to prevent unauthorised AI scraping of creative and cultural content.	Supported by Member State data protection frameworks
Civil Society & Academia	Independent monitoring	Document and report AI-led surveillance, biodiversity loss, and coercive acts to the Future Generations Ombudsperson. Provide expert input into Seventh Generation Audit panels.	Protected by journalist protection protocol (§6.2)
Indigenous Communities	Custodianship of traditional ecological knowledge	Traditional ecological knowledge is sovereign data — it cannot be extracted, trained upon by AI, or commodified without free, prior, and informed consent of the community, and without fair and ongoing compensation.	LDLA guardianship principles; SDVO enforcement
Private Sector & Technology Companies	Responsible innovation	Comply with Sovereign Data Royalty (Article IV). Adopt Human-in-the-Loop standard (Article I §6) as a condition of operating in GSC member markets. No agentic AI in nuclear-adjacent systems (Article I §7).	Licensing conditional on compliance; violations trigger Coercion Penalty

Section 6.2 — Journalist Protection Protocol

Truth is peace infrastructure. Without accurate information, no peace framework can be built on shared reality.

- Guarantee the physical safety of journalists covering conflict zones;
- Criminalise the deliberate targeting of journalists or journalistic infrastructure by state or state-affiliated actors;
- Establish national rapid-response units capable of identifying and publicly flagging disinformation, synthetic media, and AI-generated fake statements by political leaders within 24 hours;
- Support and fund independent public media through mechanisms insulated from government political interference.

Section 6.3 — 'One Orbit — Many Voices': The Global Cultural Exchange Programme

ONE ORBIT — MANY VOICES: A permanent civil society initiative embedded in the GSC framework, connecting young people across conflict zones and geopolitical fault lines through shared human experience — not through politics.

Inspired by 'ping-pong diplomacy' of 1971, in which a table tennis match between US and Chinese athletes opened the diplomatic channel that transformed the 20th century.

Equally inspired by the San people of southern Africa: trust is built over shared meals and shared play, before treaties are written.

Programme Components:

- SCIENCE EXCHANGE: Joint space science, climate research, and clean energy projects involving young scientists from states in active conflict or geopolitical tension, conducted through neutral intermediary institutions (modelled on CERN). Space belongs to no nation. Shared scientific purpose is humanity's oldest peace technology.

- SPORT DIPLOMACY: Joint athletics participation in international competitions, joint training camps, and GSC-sponsored inter-regional sport festivals. Member States shall field joint delegations from previously conflicting states in at least one international sports event annually.

- CULTURAL EXCHANGE: Online and in-person exchanges of music, food, art, and literary culture across conflict boundaries. Person-to-person rather than government-to-government, where ordinary citizens discover shared humanity without diplomatic mediation.

- EDUCATION EXCHANGE: Student exchange programmes between states in tension or recent conflict, funded by the Stewardship Credits mechanism. Students spend at least one academic semester in a country their government considers an adversary or rival.

- JOURNALISM EXCHANGE: Journalists from states in tension are embedded in each other's newsrooms for a minimum of three months annually, producing joint coverage of shared challenges that transcend political division.

THE STAKES: As nuclear security experts indicated, a world where every insecure nation eventually builds its own nuclear deterrent is a world that ends either in space wars or extinction. The alternative is a world where competition and disagreement are conducted between people who have eaten together, played together, and discovered that the person on the other side is fully human. Energy flows where attention goes. One Orbit is designed to shift the attention of the next generation — through direct experience — toward shared humanity and shared civilisational possibility.

ARTICLE VII: NPT TABLING MANDATE AND SIGNING MILESTONES

Section 1 — NPT Tabling Mandate

Founding Stewards are hereby mandated to table the GSC nuclear accountability provisions (Article I §4), the AI Human-in-the-Loop standard (Article I §6), the Agentic AI Prohibition (Article I §7), and the Emotional Amplification Protocol (Article I §8) as supplemental protocols to the NPT before May 1, 2026. The act of tabling establishes these provisions as part of the formal diplomatic record, creating a baseline against which future state conduct may be measured. All nuclear weapons states shall be invited to convene as a collective body — for the first time in history — to address nuclear risk as a shared problem rather than a bilateral competition.

DATE	EVENT	FORUM	MILESTONE
April 2026	Emergency outreach to prospective Tier 1 Founding Stewards	Bilateral diplomatic channels and civil society networks	Charter shared; feedback incorporated; verbal commitments sought
April 27 – May 22, 2026	NPT Review Conference Engagement	UN Headquarters, New York	Founding Stewards table GSC nuclear accountability, AI, and agentic AI provisions; One Orbit programme launches; all eight nuclear states invited to collective dialogue
May 2026	Technology and AI Governance Ministerial	G7 Presidency forum	Table AI Human-in-Loop standard and Emotional Amplification Protocol as multilateral consensus items
June 5, 2026	FOUNDING CHARTER SIGNING — World Environment Day	San José, Costa Rica	Full Charter signed by Tier 1 Founding Stewards and confirmed Tier 2 members. GSC formally operational.
September 2026	First Council Assembly	San José, Costa Rica	Inaugural session; first Planetary Boundary Report; first Geopolitical AI Risk Report; election of Stewardship Commission and Secretary-General

ARTICLE VIII: AMENDMENT, WITHDRAWAL, AND SUSPENSION

Section 1 — Amendment Procedure

Any Member State may propose an amendment by submitting the proposed text to the Stewardship Commission with a written rationale. Following a six-month public consultation period, the proposal requires a 75% weighted majority vote and ratification by 2/3 of member states within 18 months to enter into force.

The following core principles are UNAMENDABLE under any threshold: (a) abolition of the veto; (b) Human-in-the-Loop standard for AI in targeting; (c) Agentic AI Prohibition in nuclear systems; (d) Seventh Generation Audit requirement; (e) prohibition on nuclear use as grounds for emergency response; (f) consultative standing of the Indigenous Elders Council; (g) One Orbit — Many Voices programme mandate.

Section 2 — Withdrawal

Any Member State may withdraw with 24 months' notice to the Secretary-General. Financial obligations survive withdrawal and remain legally enforceable. Re-accession requires 60% weighted majority approval.

Section 3 — Suspension

A Member State may be suspended — but not expelled — by a 2/3 emergency weighted majority for: military aggression against a Member State without Council authorisation; refusal to comply with two consecutive binding Dispute Resolution Chamber findings; systematic genocide, mass atrocity, or crimes against humanity; or deployment of agentic AI in nuclear systems in violation of Article I §7. A suspended member retains observer status and the right to address the Assembly — ensuring all actors remain at the table.

ARTICLE IX: ENTRY INTO FORCE, OFFICIAL LANGUAGES, AND TREATY RELATIONSHIPS

Section 1 — Entry Into Force

This Charter enters into force when signed by a minimum of five Tier 1 Founding Steward nations, provided that at least one signatory is from each of the following blocs: South Asia or the Indo-Pacific; Europe or the EU; and one additional democratic G7 state.

Section 2 — Official Languages

Arabic, Chinese (Mandarin), English, French, Hindi, Portuguese, Russian, and Spanish. The English and French texts are equally authoritative for legal interpretation.

Section 3 — Relationship to Existing Treaty Obligations

GSC membership does not require Member States to violate their existing treaty obligations. Where a GSC Council Assembly resolution conflicts with a UN Security Council resolution, the GSC Assembly shall convene an emergency session within 72 hours to determine whether to: (a) defer to the UN resolution; (b) seek mediation between the two bodies; or (c) by 2/3 emergency majority, maintain the GSC resolution as the operative standard for its members.

SUPPORTING EVIDENCE: KEY REFERENCES

Earth Stewardship and Trusteeship

- Maastricht Principles on Future Generations (OHCHR): https://www.ohchr.org
- Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework — 30x30 target aligns with GSC Biodiversity Index
- Earth Trusteeship Initiative — international law from ownership to guardianship
- Stockholm Resilience Centre — Planetary Boundaries: https://www.stockholmresilience.org
- IPBES Global Biodiversity Assessment: https://www.ipbes.net

Nuclear Risk and Accountability

- Bulletin of the Atomic Scientists — Doomsday Clock (90 seconds to midnight): https://thebulletin.org
- Arms Control Association — New START Expiry and NPT Timeline: https://www.armscontrol.org
  FAS — World Nuclear Forces 2026: https://fas.org/initiative/status-world-nuclear-forces/
  ICAN — Campaign to Abolish Nuclear Weapons (Nobel Peace Prize): https://www.icanw.org
- IAEA — Official Mail and Nuclear Monitoring: https://www.iaea.org/contact/official-mail
- IAEA Iran Reports: https://www.iaea.org/topics/monitoring-and-verification-in-iran
- NPT RevCon 2026 Official: https://www.un.org/en/conferences/treaty-on-the-non-proliferation-of-nuclear-weapons-npt-2026
- DefenseScoop April 2026: www.defensescoop.com/2026/04/01/army-tests-lumberjack-drone-maven-smart-system/
- TRENDS Research: www.trendsresearch.org/insight/governing-lethal-autonomous-weapons-the-future-of-warfare-and-military-ai/
- RobotToday: www.robottoday.com/article/future-warfare-the-autonomy-spectrum

AI Governance

- EU AI Act — Official Text: https://artificialintelligenceact.eu
- UN General Assembly Resolution 78/265 — first global AI governance resolution
- UN GA Resolution 79/239 — AI in the military domain (2025)
- Rome Statute of the ICC — Command Responsibility (Article 28)
- Vatican — Antiqua et Nova: Note on AI and Human Intelligence (January 2025): https://www.vatican.va/roman_curia/congregations/cfaith/documents/rc_ddf_doc_20250128_antiqua-et-nova_en.html
- REAIM Call to Action — 60+ nations on responsible AI in military
- HumanX 2026 — Al Gore / Dr Eric Topol on AI governance: https://www.humanx.co

Cultural Exchange and Peace Infrastructure

- Jeffrey D. Sachs & Sybil Fares — Ending Israel's War on Peace: https://www.commondreams.org/opinion/israel-war-on-peace
- Ping-Pong Diplomacy historical record — US National Archives
- San people social technology — Kalahari research, Richard Lee anthropological documentation
- St Francis of Assisi Prayer of Peace — foundational text for One Orbit programme

Historical Context — Root Cause Doctrine

- National Security Archive — 1953 Iran Coup (Operation Ajax): https://nsarchive2.gwu.edu/NSAEBB/NSAEBB435/
- JCPOA documentation and unilateral withdrawal records: https://www.armscontrol.org
- Freedom House — Freedom in the World: https://freedomhouse.org
- V-Dem Institute — Democracy Report: https://grupoorinoco.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/04/v-dem_institute_democracy_report_2026.pdf

JOINT SIGNING STATEMENT — JUNE 5, 2026

World Environment Day · San José, Costa Rica

"In San José, we plant the seed of a new order —
not one based on the power to destroy, but on the duty to protect.
We invite all nations who believe that sovereignty is stewardship,
that data is culture, that future generations have rights,
that the Earth is not ours to exhaust,
and that our children deserve a future among the stars —
to sign this Charter and stand with us."

— Founding Stewards of the Global Stewardship Council

June 5, 2026 · World Environment Day · San José, Costa Rica

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